

FIVE PHASES OF PROJECT MANAGEMENT LIFECYCLE

The project management lifecycle is a step-by-step framework of best practices used to shepherd a project from initiation to conclusion. By following each step, teams increase their chances of achieving their goals, including meeting crucial deadlines and staying within budget.

PHASES

The five phases of the project management lifecycle are:

- Initiating
- Planning
- Executing
- Monitoring and controlling
- Closing

1. Initiating

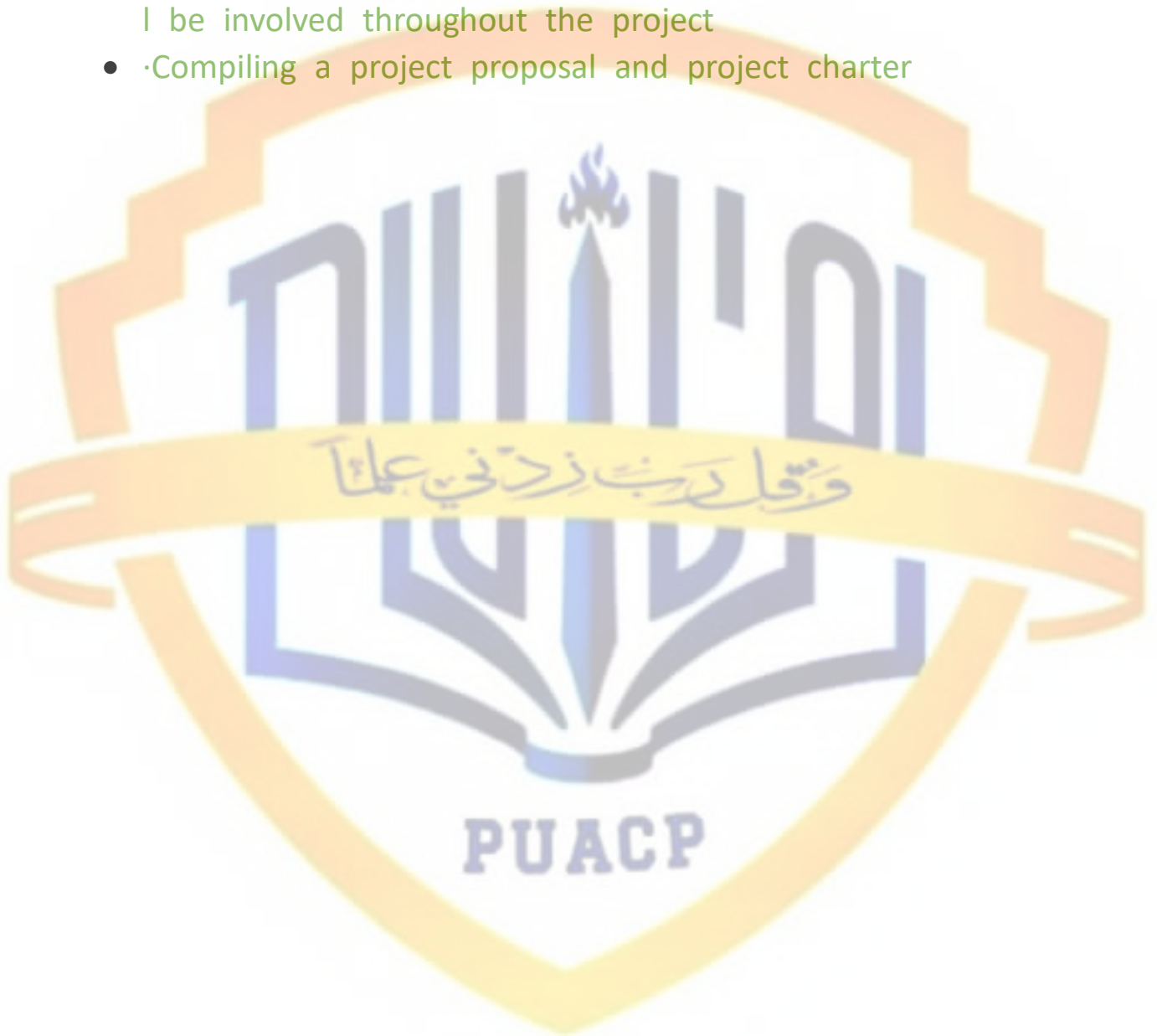
This is a crucial phase to the project's success because it gives the team direction. Without clarity around what needs to be achieved and why, the project runs the risk of not accomplishing the end goals and meeting stakeholders' expectations.

In the initiation phase, you will define the project, including its purpose, goals, scope, resources, team roles, and stakeholder expectations.

The initiation phase can include the following steps:

- Communicating with stakeholders to understand the purpose and desired outcomes

- ·Identifying project scope
- ·Determining specific,measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound goals (or SMART goals)
- ·Clarifying resources like budget and time constraints
- ·Confirming team size and roles required
- ·Determining how often and which stakeholders will be involved throughout the project
- ·Compiling a project proposal and project charter



2.Planning

In the planning phase, you'll determine the steps to actually achieve the project goals. In other words, the “how” of completing a project. If the initiation phase involves assembling your troops, the planning phase involves deciding what to do with them.

You'll establish budgets, timelines, milestones, source materials, and necessary documents. This step also involves calculating and predicting risk, implementing change processes, and outlining communication protocols.

The planning phase can include the following steps:

- Deciding on milestones that lead up to goal completion
- Developing a schedule for tasks and milestones, including time estimates and buffers
- Establishing change processes
- Determining how and how often to communicate with team members and stakeholders
- Creating and signing documents such as non-disclosure agreements (NDAs) or requests for proposal (RFPs)
- Assessing and managing risk by creating a risk register
- Holding a kick-off meeting to start the project

3.Executing

Executing a project means putting your plan into action and keeping the team on track. Generally, this means tracking and measuring progress, managing quality, mitigating risk, managing the budget, and using data to inform your decisions.

The execution phase can include the following steps:

- Using tools like Gantt or burndown charts to track progress on tasks
- Responding to risks when they manifest
- Recording costs
- Keeping team members motivated and on task
- Keeping stakeholders informed of progress
- Incorporating changes via change requests



4. Monitoring and controlling

Although "monitoring and controlling" is labeled as the fourth step, it typically takes place concurrently with the execution phase. You'll be responsible for monitoring the project's performance, gathering key data to determine whether it's performing in line with the project plan. If not, you will control the issues that need to be addressed.

Steps in the monitoring & controlling phase can include:

- Setting quality assurance (QA) protocols
- Using project monitoring tools
- Gathering relevant project data
- Identifying any issues (or risks) that arise
- Digesting that data into project reports

5. Closing

In the closing phase of the project management lifecycle, you'll conclude project activities, turn the finished product or service over to its new owners, and assess the things that went well and didn't go so well. It'll also be a time to celebrate your hard work.

Steps in the closing phase can include:

- Conducting retrospectives and taking notes of changes you can implement in the future

- Communicating to stakeholders about the end of the project and providing an impact report
- Communicating with the new owners of a project
- Creating a project closeout report
- Celebrating the end of the project and your successes

